

September 23, 2026 · James McDaniel

Why connect

Claude only knows what you paste into it or what it learned in training. It can't see what's actually happening in your deals. Once Backstory is connected, Claude can:

- Look up any account and pull its status, open opportunities, and scorecards
 - Summarize recent activity and show who's engaged on a deal
 - Answer SalesAI questions and find comparable past deals with Situation Search
- Reps ask Claude about a deal and get an answer built on real activity data.

At a glance

Server URL	https://mcp.backstory.ai/mcp
Authentication	OAuth 2.0, dynamic discovery
What you configure by hand	Just the URL. No client IDs, secrets, or scopes.
Who signs in	Each user, with their own Backstory login. Data is scoped to what the user can see in Backstory.

How auth works Backstory MCP uses OAuth 2.0 with dynamic discovery. Claude reads the authorization endpoints from the server itself, so there are no client IDs, secrets, or scopes to configure by hand. You sign in once and the connector stays connected until you disconnect it.

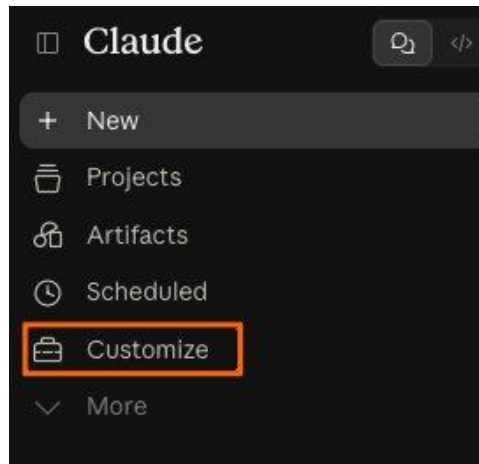
Before you start

- A Claude account on a plan that supports custom connectors (Pro, Max, Team, or Enterprise). On Team and Enterprise, an Owner may need to add the connector for the organization before members can connect.
- Your Backstory sign-in: your email and your company identification. The connection authenticates as you, so Claude sees only the data your Backstory user can see.
- The MCP server URL below, the only value you have to paste.

MCP server URL <https://mcp.backstory.ai/mcp>

1. Open Customize

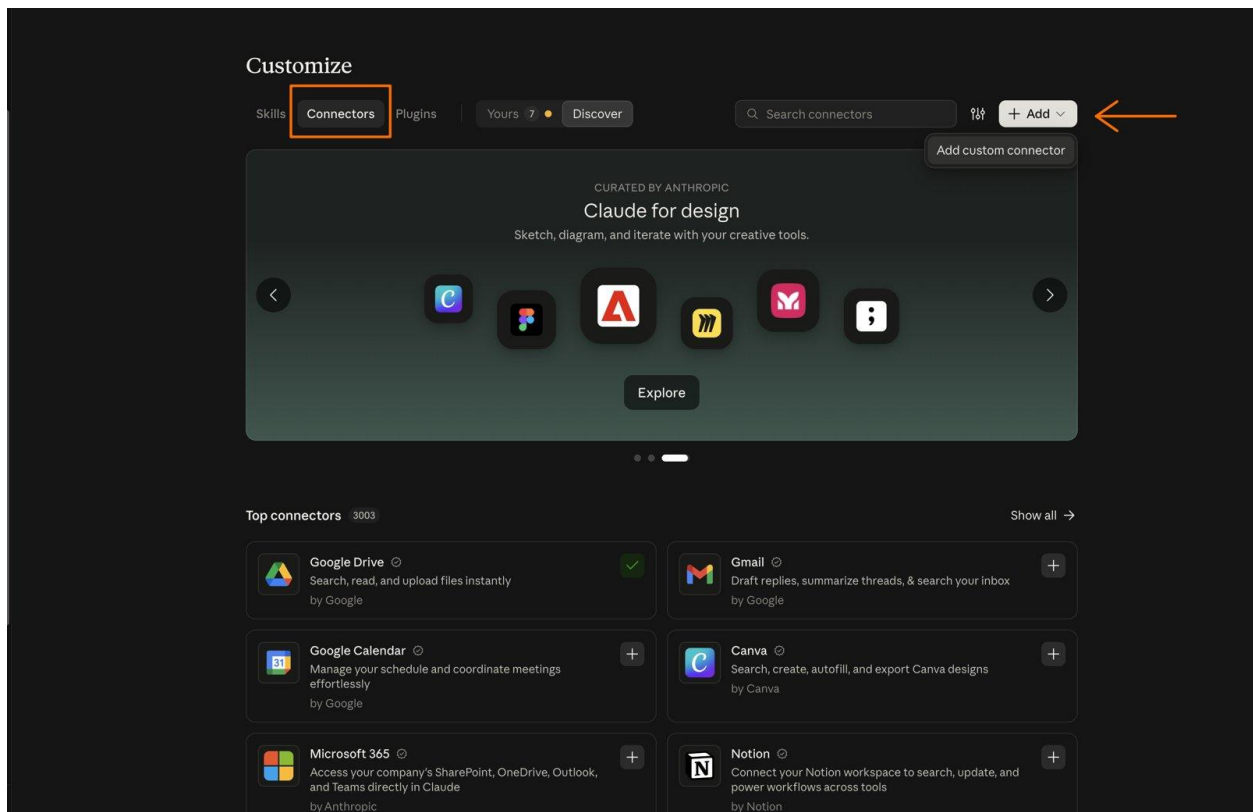
Select **Customize** in the left sidebar.



Sidebar → Customize

2. Add a custom connector

Select the **Connectors** tab, then **+ Add** in the top-right corner and choose **Add custom connector**. Skip the Discover catalog; Backstory is added by URL.



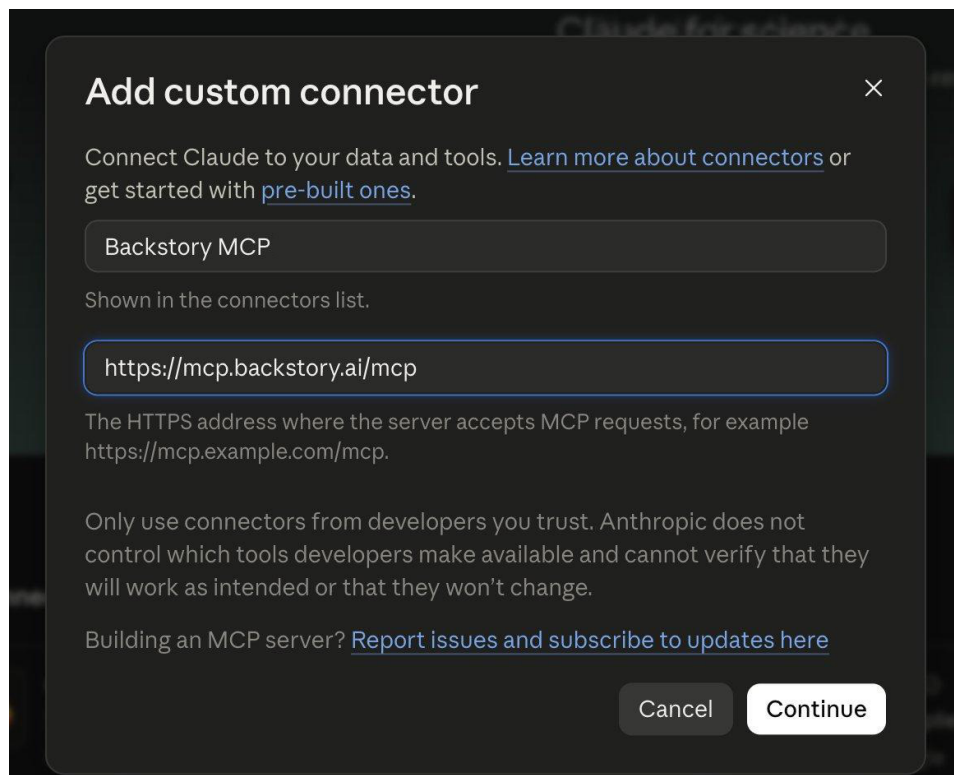
Customize → Connectors → + Add → Add custom connector

3. Enter the server details

Fill in the Add custom connector form, then select **Continue**:

Field	Value
Name	Backstory MCP (shown in the connectors list)

Remote MCP server URL	https://mcp.backstory.ai/mcp
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Add custom connector → Continue

Name it clearly A name like **Backstory MCP** is easy to find in the connectors list and the chat tools menu.

Watch the URL The path matters: the URL ends in /mcp. A trailing slash or a missing path is the most common reason the connection fails and no tools appear.

4. Sign in to Backstory

A Backstory sign-in window opens. Enter your email and your company identification and select **Sign In**, or use **Sign in with only an email address** to get a link instead. The second field is the company ID, not a password. Approve the consent prompt if one appears; the window closes when authentication succeeds.

Sign In

Unlock your complete story with Backstory

Sign In

Sign in with only an email address

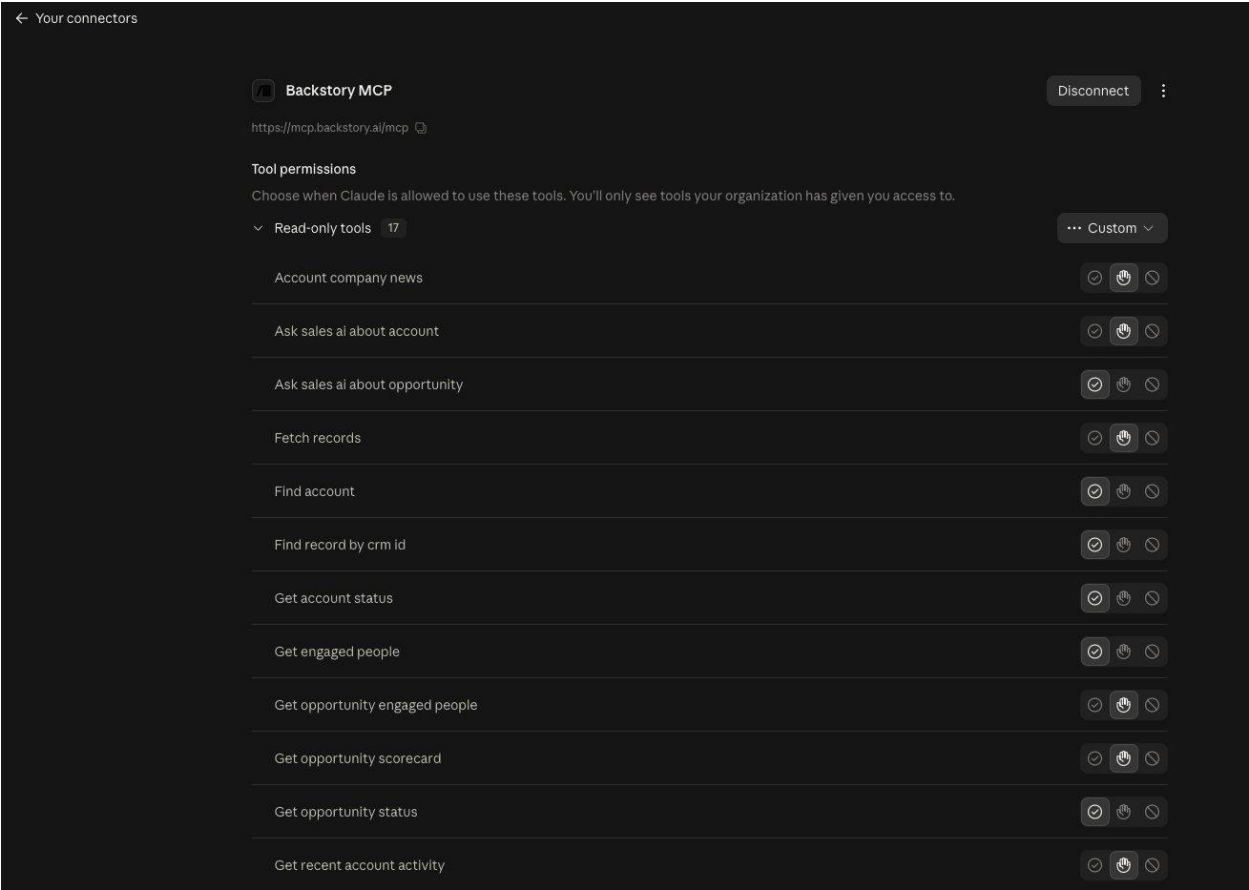
[TERMS OF SERVICE](#) [PRIVACY POLICY](#) [SECURITY & TRUST](#)

Backstory sign-in

Popups If nothing happens after **Continue**, the sign-in window was blocked. Allow popups for claude.ai and try again.

5. Set tool permissions

After sign-in, the connector page lists all 17 Backstory tools under **Read-only tools**. Each tool has three settings: ***always allow***, ***needs approval***, and ***never***. Set them individually, or use the dropdown at the top of the list to apply one setting to every tool. Use the table below if you're unsure which to pick.



Your connectors → Backstory MCP → Tool permissions

Setting	What it does	Suggested for
Always allow	Claude calls the tool without asking	Lookups and status: Find account, Find record by CRM ID, Get account status, Get opportunity status, Get engaged people
Needs approval	Claude asks before each call	Heavier or broader calls: Fetch records, SalesAI questions, company news, recent activity, scorecards
Never	Tool is hidden from Claude	Anything you don't want it to use

All read-only Every Backstory tool reads data and none can change your CRM, so “**Always allow**” across the board is safe. Approval prompts are useful if you want to see each call as it happens.

6. Use Backstory in a chat

Start a new chat, open the tools menu from the + in the message box, and make sure **Backstory MCP** is switched on. Claude then decides when to call Backstory based on your question.

Verify

- Ask something only Backstory can answer, such as “**What’s the current status of [one of your accounts]?**”

- Expand the tool call in Claude's response to confirm it called a Backstory tool rather than answering from general knowledge.
- If a tool is set to ***needs approval***, approve the prompt; the answer continues once the call returns.

Troubleshooting

No Add custom connector option. Your plan doesn't support custom connectors, or your organization restricts them. On Team or Enterprise, ask an owner to add Backstory for the organization.

Connection fails after Continue. Check the URL ends in /mcp with no trailing slash. Remove the connector from **Your Connectors** and add it again.

Sign-in window never opens. Popups are blocked, or an earlier Backstory session in the same browser is interfering. Allow popups for claude.ai, or retry in a private window.

Fewer than 17 tools listed. You only see tools your organization has given you access to. Ask your Claude organization owner to check the connector's tool settings.

Claude answers without calling Backstory. The connector is off for this chat, or the prompt is too generic. Check the tools menu and name Backstory or a specific account in the question.

Wrong or empty data. Results are scoped to the Backstory user who authenticated. Confirm you signed in with the right company identification.

Need to reconnect. Open **Customize** → **Connectors** → **Yours**, select Backstory MCP, and choose **Disconnect**, then connect again.